

# IPCop

## Should You Upgrade to 2.0.4?



Part—7

This series on IPCop (1.4.21), which began in December 2011, has covered the basic installation, configuration and add-ons to construct a full-featured firewall. The last article, published in May 2012, took a nostalgic look at IPCop 1.4.21. Version 2.0, which was released in September 2011, has evolved to 2.0.4, released on February 16, 2012. This article will help you decide on whether to upgrade to this latest version or not, while covering basic installation.

The improvements in the latest stable release, from the IPCop viewpoint, are as follows:

- Linux kernel 2.6.32—added compatibility with many of the latest Ethernet cards, SATA hard disks and optical drives.
- New hardware support, including Cobalt, Sparc and PPC platforms—increased compatibility.
- A new installer, which allows you to install to flash or hard drives, and to select interface cards and assign them to particular networks—easy installation and Ethernet card detection or allocation.
- HTTPS port changed to 8443—the earlier used Port 445 was a well-known Windows SMB port.
- The incorporation of ADV Proxy, OpenVPN, BlockOutTraffic functionality—a separate add-on installation is not required.
- All Web interface pages are now password protected—better security.
- Several new Web interface pages.

And the biggest disappointment? Contrary to the expectations of many hard-core IPCopians, dual WAN functionality has not been implemented.

### Which version should one install?

To those of you who wish to install IPCop for the first time, I would recommend that you first compare the old and latest release's functionalities. If the latest release fulfills your requirements, the choice is clear—go for it. However, note that some important add-ons such as Web GUI based URL Filter and WLAN AP are not yet available for the latest release. So if you need them, go for the older version, where they work perfectly.

If you wish to migrate to the latest release, analyse your set-up by using the generalised steps below.

### Migration guidelines

*Analyse the existing IPCop set-up:*

- List the add-ons used in the existing installation.
- Verify whether these add-ons are incorporated in the new version, OR if a compatible version is available for the latest release.
- Decide whether you can use the firewall without a few functions, in case of incompatible add-ons.

*The migration process:*

- Back up the existing IPCop configuration.
- Prepare an installable CD of the IPCop 2.0.3 ISO (To